Gabriel Porras Brenes

Application Security Engineer | DevSecOps

San José, Costa Rica · +506 7205-2488 · gabripb2004@gmail.com · GitHub · LinkedIn

SUMMARY

Application security engineer hardening enterprise applications for Walmart: 1,000+ SAST/SCA vulnerabilities remediated across ~50 Java and Node.js microservices, and security gates in 15 CI/CD pipelines that stop vulnerable builds before production. Full-stack background in Java, .NET and JavaScript, which lets me fix vulnerabilities in the code itself and explain them in terms developers act on. Professional English (B2+).

EXPERIENCE

Application Hardening Specialist — Babel (client: Walmart) *Sep 2025 – Present*

San José, Costa Rica

- Remediated 1,000+ vulnerabilities flagged by Snyk (SAST, SCA, container scanning), Apiiro and SonarQube across ~50 Java and Node.js microservices and Docker images, clearing Critical and High findings wherever a fix was available.
- Resolved dependency-level (SCA) findings typically within days of assignment.
- Built security and quality gates into 15 CI/CD pipelines (static analysis, functional and integration tests) that actively block promotion of builds with unresolved critical findings.
- Contributed to an automation that scans repositories and surfaces pending findings based on the team's hardening patterns, scaling remediation beyond manual review.
- Enforced TLS 1.2+, application authentication policies and consumer-subscription controls so only registered clients can call each API.
- Authored OpenAPI 3.x specifications with security schemes and error contracts using AI-assisted workflows; migrated service metadata to the enterprise API registry linked to ServiceNow APM.
- Designed API rate-limiting policies, load-tested endpoints to confirm HTTP 429 throttling, and enabled distributed tracing through Grafana.
- Estimated remediation effort per finding and documented hardening procedures adopted as team references.

Stack: *Java, Node.js, Snyk, Apiiro, SonarQube, Docker, Kubernetes, Git, OpenAPI, Grafana*

Freelance Full-Stack Software Engineer — Wyld Society *Mar 2024 – Dec 2024*

Remote · Client in Marbella, Spain

- Delivered end-to-end an iOS MVP for an events company to coordinate influencer attendance (discovery, invitations, check-ins).
- Built with FlutterFlow and Firebase, integrating REST APIs, secure authentication, persistent data models and Google Maps.
- Ran design → iterate → validate cycles directly with the client in English, reducing rework and time-to-market.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Application Security: Snyk (SAST, SCA, container scanning), Apiiro, SonarQube, Spring Security, JWT, TLS

DevOps: CI/CD security and quality gates, Docker, Kubernetes, Git/GitHub, Grafana

APIs: REST, OpenAPI 3.x / Swagger, authentication policies, rate limiting, API governance

Languages & Frameworks: Java, C#, JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, SQL, Spring Boot, .NET 8, Node.js, React, Angular

Databases: SQL Server, MySQL, Oracle, MongoDB, Firebase

PROJECTS

QuitSmoke — Smoking-cessation platform *Nov 2023*

3rd place, ExpoCenfo (Universidad Cenfotec)

- Built authentication and authorization with Spring Security and JWT, plus privacy controls for sensitive health data.
- Ingested and normalized wearable and air-quality sensor data (Arduino) for analytics dashboards. Stack: Spring Boot, Angular, AWS EC2.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Software Engineering — Universidad Cenfotec *Mar 2026*

Intensive English Course — INTENSA *2021*

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (B2+, professional) · Portuguese (A2)